

NHG Facilitator Huddle

Welcome and thank you for volunteering your time and energy to facilitate the NHG study. You might recall your experience from your first NHG meeting – all of the dings as people call in, not knowing when to be on mute or exactly where to go or what to say. Having a facilitator there to encourage you and guide the meeting is a tremendous gift. During the Huddle, we will define the role of the facilitator, cover logistics for each meeting, go over the steps for running a meeting, and share general tips for staying in your skin.

Facilitator Role

Your job as a facilitator is to guide students through each reading guide in a relaxed and trustworthy environment. This is your opportunity to develop valuable skills in the non-judgmental freedom of the KF community. You are offering a gift to others by facilitating and the community is ready to help and to applaud!

<i>We are:</i>	<i>We may:</i>	<i>We are not:</i>
○ Primarily here for our own training ○ Volunteers, giving a gift ○ Observers ○ Heading into the not-knowing ○ Simply trying something new	○ Have technological glitches ○ Not know the answers ○ Ask our community for support	○ Counselors ○ Teachers ○ Performers ○ Subject matter experts ○ Nancy

Guidelines for NHG Meetings

Working together over the phone and internet presents some extra challenges. We cannot pick up the same kinds of communication signals that we might find talking face to face. To help the meetings flow in a timely manner we have developed some guidelines and have borrowed others from Karis Fellowships training which apply to NHG study groups:

We cooperate for the security and efficiency of the group.

We adhere to the time restraints (so that NHG meetings don't run overtime).

We present ourselves authentically.

We hold in sacred confidence what we learn about each other.

We withhold opinions on outside issues while in the meeting.

We take turns speaking and answering as the facilitator directs us.

We respect the facilitators and follow their guidance.

We support the goal of finishing the designated reading guides for that lesson.

We offer our own thoughts and experience during the free discussion time.

We avoid correcting or embellishing the thoughts of others.

A step-by-step guide to running a meeting

1. Prepare before the meeting:

- Offer yourself time to settle down before you call in.

- Try a Tap, Alternate Nostril Breathing, or other KF tools that work for you.
- Consider and note your own answers to the Presenting Question in your Breakout Group, and your answer to the open-ended questions in your particular reading guide.

2. Gather your materials:

- Writing tools and notepad
- Print and fill out **NHG Facilitator Guide**
- **NHG Facilitator Answer Guide** for your specific chapters
- The **NHG Chapter Introduction(s)** for your specific chapters
- Access **NHG Attendance Spreadsheet** on the NHG Facilitator Info page on website
- Water

3. Call in to the meeting 5-10 minutes prior to start time:

- If you are Lead Facilitator (host), press * instead of # after access code to be able to start and end the recording.
- Ask general questions as students call in. Example, “How’s the weather there?”

4. Lead Facilitator starts meeting:

- Refer to NHG Facilitator Guide to launch the meeting.
- Start the recording on the hour.
- Ask a veteran KF member to read NHG Chapter Intro.
- Remind the groups to come back to the main group on time.
- Assign Breakout Groups to “rooms” and dismiss groups. Remain in main group to lead.

5. Support Facilitator leads the discussion in Breakout Rooms:

- Open Presenting section from the NHG Facilitator Answer Guide.
- Track attendance as students present.
- Ask if everyone is able to answer questions on the reading guide. Record completed reading guides on the attendance spreadsheet.
- Begin assigning questions in chunks of 3-5 questions pausing as needed for discussion.
- Support Facilitator might keep track of time according to the suggested time markers on the Facilitator Answer Guide. Suggested time appears in **red** for weekly meetings and **green** for Weekend Intensive.

6. Ending the Meeting

- Return to the main group on time for closing questions and announcements.
- Lead Facilitator ends at the hour with, “Thank you for coming everyone, Goodbye.”
- Wait on the call until everyone else hangs up and end the recording.

7. After the Meeting

- Each facilitator record attendance and homework completion on the NHG Attendance Spreadsheet for the NHG students who were assigned to your breakout group.

Other Helpful Tips

For Staying in Your Skin

- Don't teach or expound on the material, but feel free to use the notes that follow each question.
- Beware of the compelling need to turn the NHG lesson into a personal counseling session for yourself or someone else.
- If stumped by a student's question, defer to Nancy if she is there or say something like, "That's a great question. Let me make a note and we can ask Nancy when there's an opportunity."

For Moving the Meeting Along

- To finish on time:
 - Timing markers in red or green are on the **Facilitator Answer Guide**. These markers help you generally know what question to be asking at that time. For example, (0:15) marks fifteen minutes into the meeting. You should be asking the marked question around that time to maintain the meeting schedule. Time markers will help you decide whether to speed the meeting up or slow it down.
- When you are ahead of schedule:
 - Pause a few seconds between questions to invite participation. Breathe and count to 10.
 - Ask Nancy or a veteran NHG facilitator to offer additional insight.
 - Read facilitator notes that are interesting to you or that you think the group might find helpful.
 - Assign fewer questions at a time (3 at a time), especially if the material is dense or invites personal answers. Ask for comments or questions between questions.
- When you are behind schedule:
 - Ask for questions or comments after every 10 questions as opposed to every 5 questions.
 - If really pressed for time and the group is behind schedule, mention the need to catch up and quickly answer a few questions yourself to get back on schedule.
 - If the group needs further clarification recommend that the group offers their questions again at the end of the meeting.
- To encourage more participation within the group:
 - If one voice is dominating the discussion, begin addressing questions to specific students in the group or to veteran facilitators and KF members. You might say something like, "Okay, thank you...[pause]... What about anyone else? Did anyone else have thoughts about this section?"
 - The timing markers can help you direct those who talk a lot. You can say, "I'm sorry to interrupt, but I see that we've run behind schedule. Jessica, would you please continue with question four?"

- If someone has a different or incorrect answer:
 - You might say something like, “What an interesting perspective! I hadn’t thought of it that way – would anyone else like to share their answer to the question?” After others share, read the answer from the Facilitator Answer Guide and then move on.

Review NHG Facilitator Guide

Start by explaining the muting functions and codes in the first table at the top of the guide.

Sometimes a student forgets to mute their microphone or disrupts the group in some other way. When this happens, remind the entire group to be sure to mute their microphones. If the problem continues, tell the group to wait a few seconds and then unmute themselves by tapping *6. You will mute the entire group with *51 and then wait for individuals to unmute themselves.

Practice the muting and unmuting. Mute the entire group with *51. Wait a few seconds and then unmute yourself with *6. Announce yourself when you have unmuted and remind the group to unmute with *6.

Continue reviewing the NHG Facilitator Guide and ask if there are any questions.

End this meeting on time and stop the recording.